

100 Days of Linux - Day 019

Title: Creating and Organizing Notes with nano

Today's Goal

Strengthen your Nano skills by creating, editing, and organizing multiple text files while reviewing previous file-viewing commands.

Why This Matters

Developers and data engineers regularly edit configuration files, documentation, SQL scripts, and notes directly in the terminal.

Commands Reviewed Today

nano, cat, head, tail, less, more, pwd, ls, mkdir, cd

Beginner Lesson

Today is about becoming comfortable with editing files. You'll create folders, write notes using Nano, and verify your work with the file-viewing commands you've already learned.

Practice Questions

1. Create a directory named `study_notes` and move into it.
2. Using Nano, create `linux_notes.txt` with at least 15 lines describing commands learned so far. Save and exit.
3. Display the first 5 lines and the last 5 lines of `linux_notes.txt`.
4. Open `linux_notes.txt` using `less`, search for the word 'Linux', then quit. Afterwards, display the file using `cat`.
5. List all files in the current directory and print your current working directory.

Hints

Remember: Ctrl+O to save, Enter to confirm, Ctrl+X to exit Nano. Use head and tail with the -n option.

Mini Challenge

Create a folder named `daily_logs`. Inside it create `day1.txt`, `day2.txt` and `day3.txt` using Nano. Add different text to each file, then verify them with `cat` and `head`.

Common Mistakes

Forgetting to save changes before closing Nano or trying to use head/tail on files that have too few lines.

Did You Know?

Many Linux configuration files are edited with terminal editors

because graphical editors aren't always available on servers.

Pro Tip

Use meaningful filenames like `project_notes.txt` or `server_log.txt` so they're easy to identify later.

Answer Key (Instructor Only)

Q1: `mkdir study_notes && cd study_notes`

Q2: `nano linux_notes.txt` (Ctrl+O, Enter, Ctrl+X)

Q3: `head -n 5 linux_notes.txt && tail -n 5 linux_notes.txt`

Q4: `less linux_notes.txt` (l, q) then `cat linux_notes.txt`

Q5: `ls && pwd`

Homework

Create another notes file about your favorite Linux commands and practice opening it with `cat`, `less`, and `more`.

Next Day Preview

Tomorrow you'll complete Module 2 with a comprehensive practical workflow before moving to searching files using `find`, `locate`, `grep`, and wildcards.